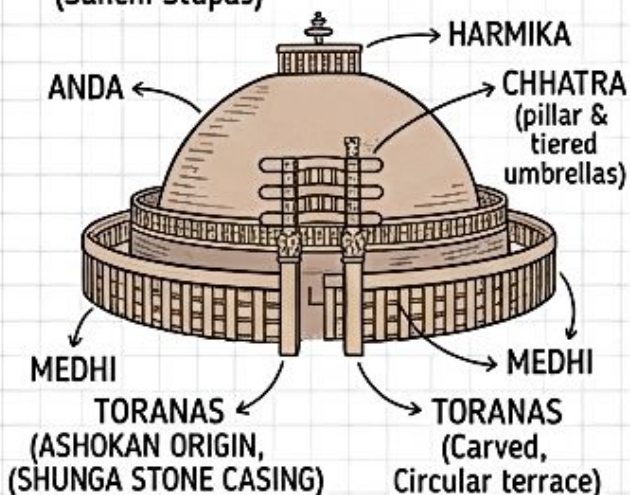


INDIAN ARCHITECTURE COMPREHENSIVE REVISION NOTEBOOK

FOR UPSC PRELIMS 2026

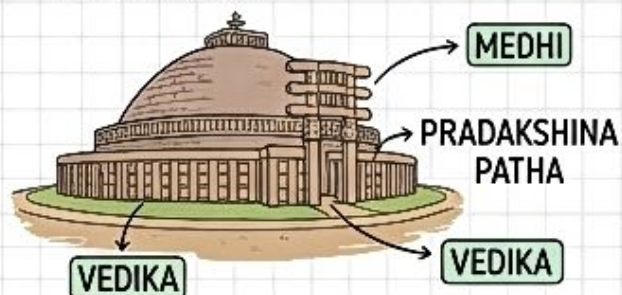
STUPA ARCHITECTURE - SANCHI

→ Relics of Buddha/Disciples (Sanchi Stupas)



→ Relics of Buddha/Disciples
→ Stone casing added later
→ Medikaneeruric/hemination

→ Elaborate Torana carvings depicting Jataka stories



ROCK-CUT ARCHITECTURE - AJANTA & ELLORA



AJANTA (29 Caves)



Cave 19 (Chaitya)



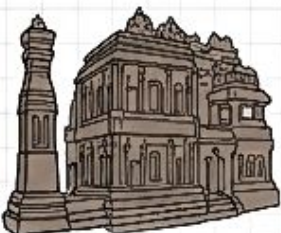
Cave 19 (Chaitya)

- 2nd BCE - 6th CE
- Exclusively BUDDHIST (Hinayana/Mahayana)
- FRESCO PAINTINGS - Natural Pigments
- Vakataka & Gupta patronage

ELLORA (34 Caves)



5th CE - 11th CE



Cave 16 (Kailashnath Temple)

- 5th CE - 11th CE
- Multi-Religious (Brahmanical, Buddhist, Jain)
- MONOLITHIC KAILASHNATH TEMPLE
- Rashtrakuta & Yadava patronage

TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE STYLES

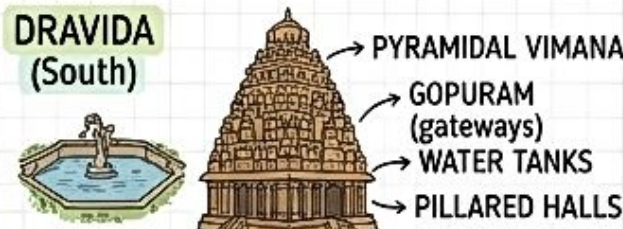


NAGARA (North)



Examples: KANDARIYA MAHADEV, KONARK

DRAVIDA (South)



Examples: BRIHADISVARA, MEENAKSHI

VESARA (Hybrid)

- Chalukya & Hoysala patrons
- Combination of styles



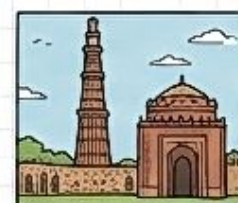
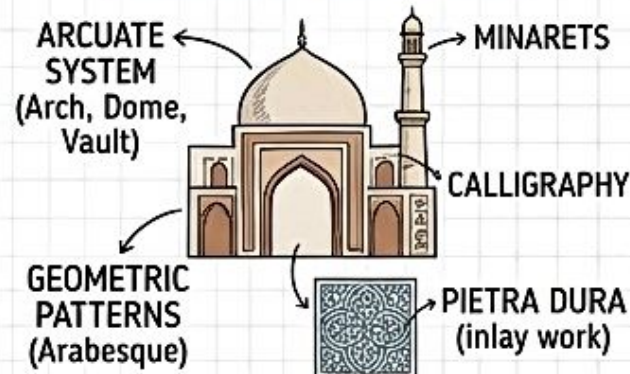
TERMINOLOGY DEFINITIONS

Garbhagriha - Curvilinear & garbhagriha
Antarala - Antarala
Water Tanks - Muhain rank & Imorarl gateways
Pillarhagriha - etc - Antahagriha
Mandapa - Labs - Rote & Murnat bar style
Vesara - Chalukya & Hoysala patrons

INDO-ISLAMIC ARCHITECTURE



SYNTHESIS: Persian + Indian



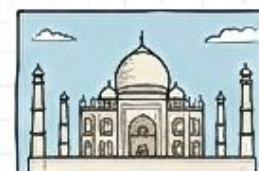
DELHI SULTANATE (Qutub Minar, Alai Darwaza)



MUGHAL STYLE



→ Materials: Red Sandstone & White Marble



MUGHAL STYLE (Humayun's Tomb - 1st Garden Tomb, Taj Mahal, Buland Darwaza)

INDIAN PAINTINGS

UPSC PRELIMS 2026



ABHISHA AI
BY ABHISHEK PATHAK

1. AJANTA MURALS (2nd BC - 7th AD)

- Technique: 'Fresco-secco' (dry plaster)
 - Cow dung, rice husk base
 - Natural minerals
- * Key feature: Rhythm, expression, absence of blue (until later)

Themes:

- Exclusively Buddhist
- Jataka Tales (stories of previous lives)



Cave wall

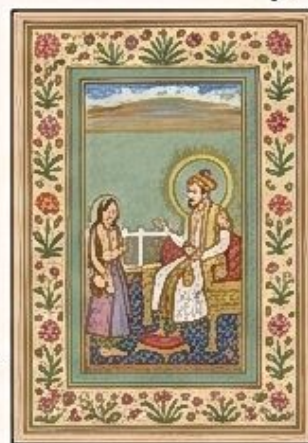


Bodhisattva Padmapani



Vajrapani (Cave 1)

• "volumes and heaviness"



2. MUGHAL PAINTINGS (16th - 19th C)

- Nature: 'Court Art' (secular, aristocratic). Not folk

AKBAR

JAHANGIR

SHAH JAHAN

- Tasvir Khana (studio)
- Manuscript illustration (Hamzanama, Tutiinama)

Artists:
Mir Sayyid Ali,
Abdus Samad

- The Zenith
- Individual Portraits
- Flora, Fauna (Ustad Mansur)
- Introduced 'Nimbus' (halo)
- European influence (foreshortening)
- Key Artist: Abu al-Hasan

- Grandeur over naturalism
- Gold/silver

Layered
Gouache

3. RAJPUT PAINTINGS (16th - 19th C)

- Nature: Rooted in tradition, 'Emotional', Vaishnavism focus
- Key Schools:

MEWAR

Bold colors,
high emotional
intensity

KISHANGARH

'Bani Thani' (Mona Lisa of India) by Nihal Chand

Distinctive features:
• Elongated eyes, sharp chin
Note: Radha-Krishna love

BUNDI-KOTA

Hunting scenes, lush
landscape/vegetation

Themes:

- Ramayana, Mahabharata
- Ragamala (musical modes)



Decline of Mughals
→ (Rajput moving) to
artists moving to
Rajput states



4. PAHARI PAINTINGS (17th - 19th C)

- Geography: Himalayan foothills
- Two Major Styles flow

BASOHLI

- Bold, intense colors
- Earliest Pahari
- Beetle-wing jewelry
- Main theme: Gita Govinda

KANGRA

- Lyrical Grace, softness
- Female beauty, landscape
- 'Cool' colors
- Gita Govinda, Bhagavad Purana



COMPARATIVE SUMMARY TABLE

Feature	Mughal	Rajput/Pahari
Theme	Secular/Court	Religious/Bhakti
Perspective	Realistic	Idealized
Influence	Persian/European	Folk/Indigenous

CLASSICAL DANCES AND MUSIC OF INDIA | PRELIMS 2026

ABHISHA AI
by Abhishek Pathak

CLASSICAL DANCES



BHARATANATYAM (Tamil Nadu)

- Oldest Form (Sadir Attam), Devadasis in temples
- Key Concept: Ekaharya (one dancer plays many roles)
- Fire Dance symbol
- Technique: Nritta, Nritya, Natya
- Signature Pos: Kataka Mukha Hasta (joining three fingers for 'Om')
- Music: Carnatic



KATHAK (North India)

- Storytellers (Kathakars)
- Unique Features: Tatkar (intricate footwork), Chakkars (rapid spins)
- Gharana System: Lucknow, Jaipur, Benaras
- Influence: Persian/Mughal (Anarkali costumes)
- Music: Hindustani



ODISSI (Odisha)

- Mobile Sculpture (carvings on Konark, etc.)
- Key Postures: Tribhanga (three-fold bend of body), Chowk (square-like masculine stance)
- Element: Water symbol
- Famous Patron: Kharavela's Hathigumpha Inscription

MUSIC SYSTEMS

HINDUSTANI vs CARNATIC MUSIC

Feature	Hindustani Music (North)	Carnatic Music (South)
Origin	Influenced by Persian/ Islamic traditions.	Indigenous; developed along original lines.
Pillars	Raga and Thaats (10 Parent Thaats).	Raga and Melakarta (72 Melakartas).
Emphasis	Instruments over vocal; focus on melody.	Vocal over instruments; focus on lyrics (Sahitya).
Improvisation	High scope for artist's freedom.	Restricted; follows fixed compositions (Kritis).
Structure	Starts with Alap (slow), then Jor and Jhala.	Starts with Varnam, then Kriti, Pallavi.
Time Rule	Specific Ragas for specific times of day.	No strict time association for Ragas.
Instruments	Tabla, Sitar, Sarangi, Santoor.	Veena, Mridangam, Ghatam, Mandolin.
Gharanas	Strong Gharana system.	No Gharana system.

QUICK "PRELIMS-READY" FACTS

- Natya Shastra: "Fifth Veda," by Bharata Muni (source)
- The Trinity of Carnatic: Tyagaraja, Muthuswami Dikshitar, Syama Sastri
- Amir Khusrau: "Father of Qawwali," shaped Hindustani, Sitar/Tabla
- Chhau Dance: Included by Ministry of Culture as 9th (SNA lists 8)